

1951, September 13

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original
by Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

September 13th 1951.

St. Felix Monastery R.R.8
Huntington, Indiana

Blessed be God in all things

God bless you Peter Doyle you and yours these days - tragic indeed but by the mercy of God, hopeful and beautiful. Yesterday, the Nativity of our blessed Mother Mary and tomorrow the exaltation of the Holy Cross; both so full of promise and consolation. I was talking with Joe. this Morning and he told me you were not very well and that you are inclined to worry, etc. Ofcourse that is a weakness of which very few of Adam's children are entirely free. Indeed it is something we all have to be on our guard against as a most insidious enemy to our peace of soul. Afterall, if we look back as many decads as possible and recollect, we will be easily convinced that our biggest worries have always been about womething that never happened; eg, twenty years ago on your way to "Good Saint Ann in Qubeck". O! Instead of worrying about anything - past or threatening to come - les us foster confidence in God by thanking Him ahead of time. No creatur, when there is question of generosity, can ever get within a weakest shadow of anythin like even dreaming to beat the Lord in generosity or anything else. But God loves to load confidently loving souls with supernatural, divine generosity.

As for what they call an anatomical operation after death; it seems to me, such a thing should be the very last thing in the world to worry about. On the contrary, while in the vast majority of such cases there is very little operating done, the idea is possibly to help some similar case or cases still suffering or to suffer in future. For my part I shall consider it as doing an act of charity after my death if they can use my old bones for fertilizing. As for worrying because about past stupidities and sins: It just seems to me that we ought to be so occupied in gratefully thanking God for having rescued us from Hell and from the jaws of our unruly passions that we should find no time to worry about anything - save possibly, that about making so little progress toward progress in the way of perfection, etc.....

Very Sincerely Yours in Jesus Sacred Heart.

Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.

(received with O'Donnell letters, Mrs. Peter Doyle
was the sister of Joseph J. O'Donnell)